BUDGETS ↑ CONFIDENCE ↓

Q3 2026 · UK MARKETING BUDGETS

What the latest IPA Bellwether means for agencies in Q4.

SWIPE FOR THE NUMBERS →

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01 · OVER A QUARTER RAISED BUDGETS

25.6%

of the IPA's UK panel raised marketing budgets in Q3, against 11.3% who cut them. Net balance +14.3%: the highest since Q2 2024, a third rise in a row.

Source: IPA Bellwether Report, Q3 2026

02 · MAIN MEDIA AT A NINE-YEAR HIGH

+9.8%

Net balance for main media advertising budgets, up from +1.5% in Q2. All five subcategories grew, the first time since tracking began in Q1 2020.

Source: IPA Bellwether Report, Q3 2026

03 · STILL DOWNBEAT ON THE INDUSTRY

34.6%

of panellists were pessimistic about industry-wide financial prospects, more than twice the 14.3% who were optimistic. Net balance: -20.3%.

Source: IPA Bellwether Report, Q3 2026

OUR TAKE

MONEY IS MOVING BEFORE CONFIDENCE

Clients are spending while still nervous. The agencies that win it will prove a return fast: automate the reporting, put the time into the analysis.

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WHAT YOU NEED

THE WEEKLY AI BRIEFING FOR AGENCIES.

One email a week. Practical, sourced, no hype.

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